

RAFAEL CARBAJAL SANCHEZ

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EDUCATION

Santa Monica College | B.S. in Interaction Design

Expected 06/27

Google UX Design Certificate, Coursera | 2025

EXPERIENCE

Snap Inc. | Snap Design Academy

Jun 2026 - Aug 2026

Design Scholar (Contract) | Los Angeles, CA

- Led UX for Resources, a Snapchat local-support concept; aligned design requirements with engineering and marketing in a cross-functional sprint that produced a functional prototype in 3 weeks.
- Used 2 rounds of research and feedback with S.P.Y. and St. Joseph Center to scope the experience around service discovery and direct handoffs to organizations equipped to provide support.
- Designed entry points across Snap Map, Search, Spotlight, and sharing to fit existing user behaviors; created interfaces within Snapchat's visual language and presented the prototype to 300+ Snap employees.

Plataforma Impact | UX Intern

Mar 2021 - Jan 2022

Mexico City, Mexico (Remote)

- Created Figma layouts and implemented front-end updates for 3 client websites, collaborating with senior designers and engineers and supporting 1 website launch.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Pantri | Meal Planning and Digital Pantry

Spring 2026

Lead UX / Product Designer | Team project

- Led UX and interface design across onboarding, meal planning, shopping, and cooking; used 13 in-store shopper interviews to shape receipt-based pantry updates that avoid manual item entry.
- Designed Figma user interface prototypes from low to high fidelity; built a 26-screen React prototype using AI-assisted coding and simulated data.
- Designed recovery paths for substitutions, quantity changes, and skipped meals after usability testing showed shoppers needed meal plans to adapt without restarting.
- Compared produce-sticker palettes in focus groups and tested with people with color vision deficiencies to refine ripeness cues within the sensing technology's color limits.

HerWay | Community Transit App

Fall 2025

Solo UX / UI Designer

- Used findings from 40 rider interviews to identify user needs and develop personas for women using public transit in South Los Angeles.
- Created 36 UI mockup screens, a 9-panel sketched journey storyboard, and an interactive Figma prototype linking route planning with community features.
- Revised navigation across 3 usability-testing rounds with 5 participants per round; brought routing and community into Home after testing showed riders overlooked features in a separate section.

Nibble | Deployed AI Portfolio Assistant

Summer 2026

Designer / Developer | Personal project

- Designed and built conversational navigation that connects visitor questions to case studies, with 4 visual states and streamed responses to communicate system progress.
- Launched an assistant that answered 400+ visitor questions in its first 4 weeks; Vercel reporting showed project pages viewed per visit rising from 1.6 to 2.3 over that period.

SKILLS

Design and research: User experience, interaction design, user flows, wireframing, prototyping, information architecture, accessibility, user interviews, usability testing, research synthesis

Tools: Figma, Adobe Creative Cloud (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign)

Development: React, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, AI-assisted coding